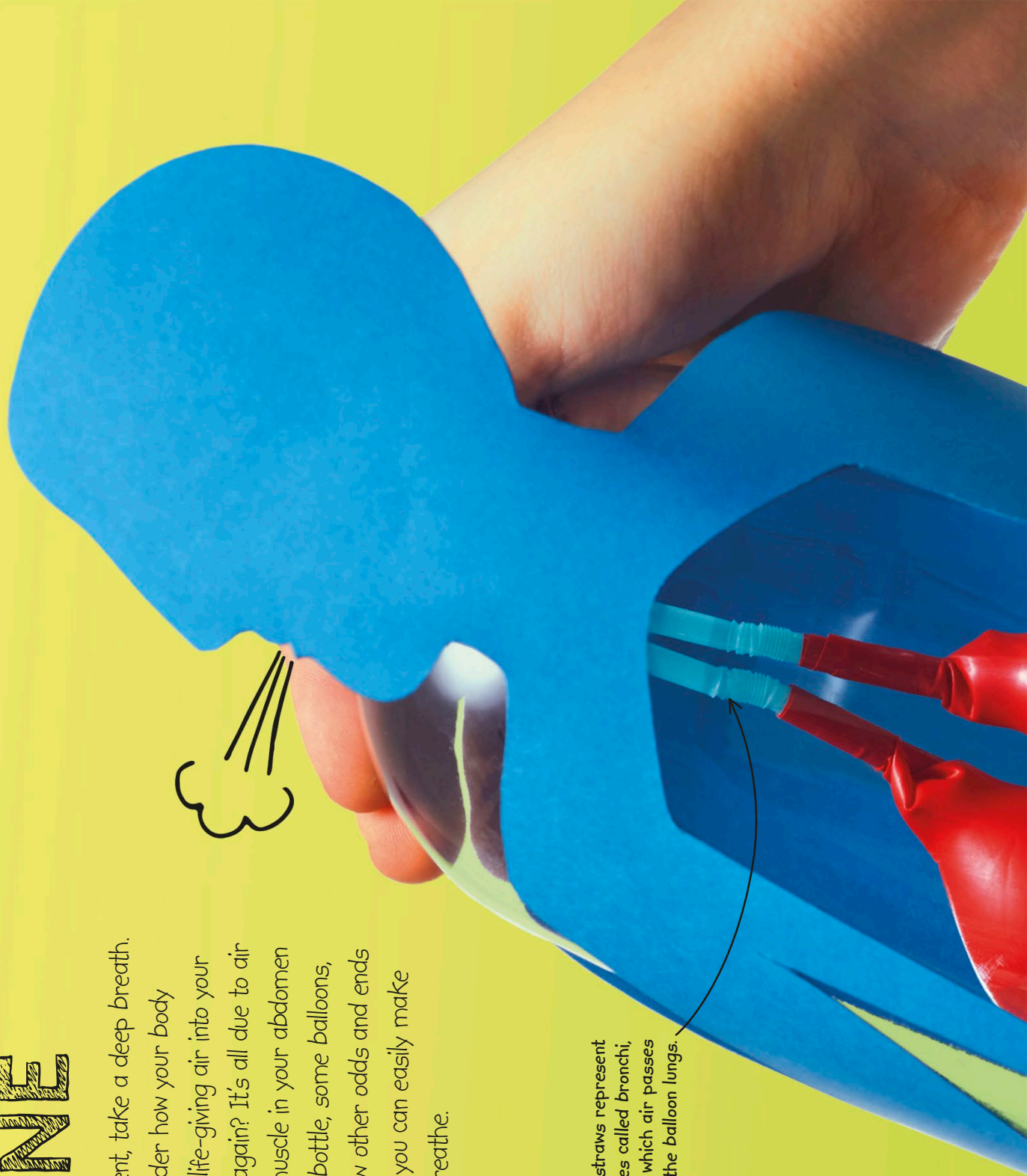


BREATHING MACHINE

Before you start this experiment, take a deep breath. Have you ever stopped to wonder how your body manages to take big gulps of life-giving air into your lungs and then breathe it out again? It's all due to air pressure, and a very special muscle in your abdomen called the diaphragm. With a bottle, some balloons, and several straws—plus a few other odds and ends you'll find around your home—you can easily make a model that shows how we breathe.



The two straws represent tubes called bronchi, through which air passes into the balloon lungs.